

Supplementary Material for

Conditional cost–emission envelopes for decarbonizing dense urban power systems under spatial renewable scarcity and flexibility constraints

This Supplementary Material provides additional data provenance, parameter definitions, model-setting details, and extended results supporting the Xinwu District analysis. It is organized to document the building-to-node demand pipeline, renewable-potential assumptions, spatial aggregation, network abstraction, temporal representation, storage and flexibility modelling, uncertainty analysis, marginal-abatement and constraint-relaxation results, and reproducibility materials.

S1 Demand modelling and spatial aggregation checks

The demand-side input package represents hourly electricity demand for 55,284 buildings in Xinwu District. Building-level loads are first assigned to 250 m grid cells and then aggregated into planning-node representations with 70, 100, and 150 nodes. The k100 aggregation is used as the baseline planning representation in the main model.

This section evaluates the aggregation in three steps. First, the land-use maps compare the spatial composition of k70, k100, and k150 nodes. Second, the retained aggregate-load comparison verifies that the independently materialized node-hour tables preserve the same district total across the three spatial resolutions retained in the data package. Third, the distributional checks compare intra-node load variability, node floor area, and node annual-load distributions across the three spatial resolutions. Together, these checks characterize whether the planning-node representation retains the dominant demand and land-use heterogeneity needed for district-scale capacity-expansion analysis.

These aggregation-consistency checks characterize the retained planning-node input package and the distribution of demand across k70, k100, and k150 representations. Feeder-level measured-load calibration requires restricted utility metering data and is therefore outside the retained public data package.

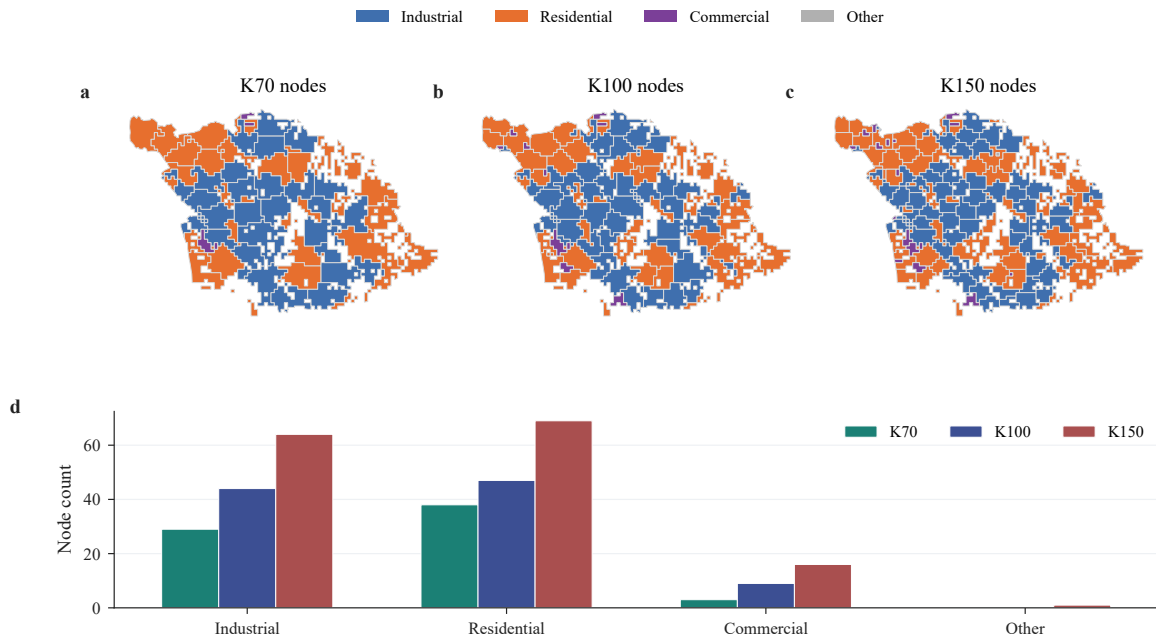


Figure S1: Land-use composition across k70, k100, and k150 aggregations. Maps show dominant node land use; bars compare node counts by land-use class.

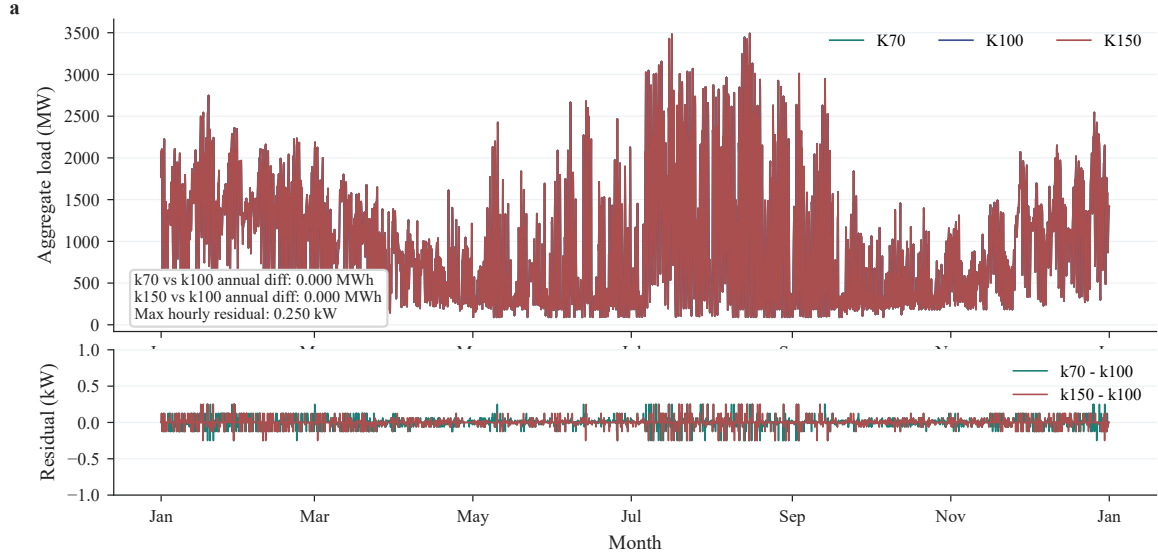


Figure S2: Aggregate-load consistency across the retained aggregation package. The upper trace compares the full-year aggregate hourly load across k70, k100, and k150 node-hour tables, and the lower trace shows pairwise residuals relative to k100.

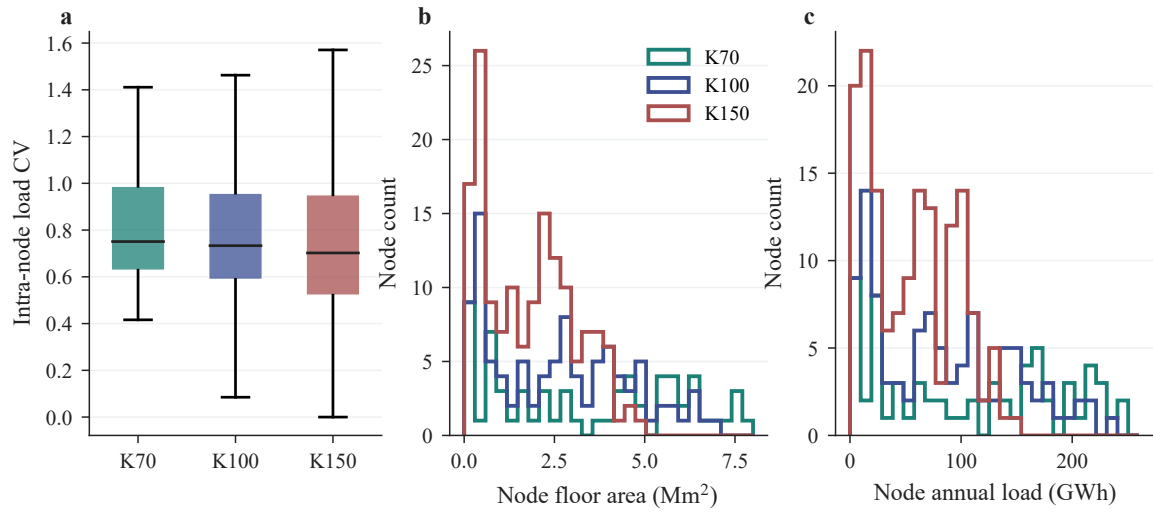


Figure S3: Distributional preservation across k70, k100, and k150 aggregations. Panels show intra-node load CV, node floor area, and node annual-load distributions.

Supplementary Figs. S1–S3 show land-use preservation, aggregate-load consistency, intra-node load dispersion, and the floor-area and load distributions across k70, k100, and k150. Tables S1 and S2 retain only the numerical scale of the demand package and the cross-resolution aggregation metrics.

Table S1: Demand package scale and aggregate consistency.

Metric	Value	Unit
Building records	55,284	buildings
Populated grid cells	2,889	250 m cells
Baseline planning nodes	100	nodes
Temporal coverage	2017 full year	hourly
Demand boundary	Electricity	–
Annual demand	8.234	TWh
Peak load	3.492	GW
Annual residual k70–k100	0.000	MWh
Annual residual k150–k100	0.000	MWh
Peak residual k70–k100	0.000	MW
Peak residual k150–k100	0.000	MW
Maximum hourly residual	0.25	kW

Data source. The demand package is derived from the UBEM-based demand integration workflow and the retained node-hour aggregation outputs. Source files are documented in the repository README and data-provenance files.

Note. The direct pre-node hourly grid-cell series is not retained in the available package. The residual rows therefore compare the retained k70 and k150 node-hour totals against the k100 baseline.

Table S2: Spatial aggregation metrics across k70, k100, and k150.

Metric	k70	k100	k150
Planning nodes	70	100	150
Assigned grid cells	2,889	2,889	2,889
Mapped buildings	55,284	55,284	55,284
Total floor area (Mm ²)	267.16	267.16	267.16
Annual demand (TWh)	8.234	8.234	8.234
Mean node load (GWh)	117.63	82.34	54.89
Median node load (GWh)	119.13	72.33	54.61
Maximum node load (GWh)	336.56	234.36	148.82
Annual-load CV	0.759	0.767	0.723
Annual-load Gini	0.433	0.435	0.413
Mean intra-node load CV	0.806	0.788	0.739
Median intra-node load CV	0.751	0.733	0.702

Note. Floor area is reported in million square metres and annual demand in terawatt-hours to keep the table compact. Distributional detail is shown in Supplementary Fig. S3.

S2 Renewable-potential assumptions and plausibility checks

PV and wind inputs enter the optimization as node-level technical capacity bounds before dispatch is optimized. The PV bound is derived from usable rooftop availability, a rooftop usability ratio, PV capacity density, and hourly PV availability factors. Candidate wind potential is treated as a site-conditioned urban resource bound based on retained land-use siting assumptions and hourly wind availability. These bounds limit installed capacity in the optimization; they are not interpreted as dispatchable annual energy that can be used without temporal, grid-interface, storage, and curtailment constraints.

Tables S3 and S4 report the capacity-density, capacity-factor, cost, and lifetime assumptions used for PV and wind. Table S5 provides plausibility checks by comparing technical potential with annual district demand and existing grid-interface capacity. These checks document the physical scale of the renewable-potential assumptions that underlie the Xinwu frontier.

Table S3: PV technical-potential assumptions.

Parameter	Value	Unit
Usable rooftop ratio	0.70	–
PV capacity density	0.200	kW m ⁻²
Total PV technical potential	5.178	GW
Mean PV capacity factor	0.1663	–
Annual PV generation potential	7.545	TWh
Node-level application	Capacity bound	–

Table S4: Wind technical-potential assumptions.

Parameter	Value	Unit
Total wind technical potential	0.925	GW
Mean wind capacity factor	0.2323	–
Annual wind generation potential	1.882	TWh
Wind base capex	10,000	CNY kW ⁻¹
Wind lifetime	25	yr
Node-level application	Capacity bound	–

Table S5: Renewable-potential plausibility metrics.

Metric	Value	Unit
Implied PV panel area	25.891	km ²
Implied rooftop area	36.986	km ²
Annual district demand	8.234	TWh
PV adequacy ratio	0.916	–
Wind adequacy ratio	0.229	–
Combined renewable adequacy ratio	1.145	–
Existing grid-interface capacity	3.851	GW
Grid-interface adequacy ratio	1.103	–

Tables S3–S5 report the numerical assumptions and plausibility metrics. The data provenance for roof-area inputs, PV capacity factors, wind profiles, and technology costs is documented in the repository README and data-provenance files.

S3 Spatial aggregation and network-abstraction inputs

This section documents the planning-node and network-abstraction inputs used to evaluate spatial sensitivity. The purpose is to separate three concepts that can otherwise be conflated: optimization feasibility under a spatial resolution, chronological-replay screening under the retained stress-period package, and planning-scale internal transfer availability under the network abstraction. The k70, k100, and k150 cases test how node resolution affects the represented demand and resource heterogeneity, while the node-interface, copperplate, and spatial-transfer cases bracket internal transfer availability.

Tables S6–S9 retain the numerical summaries used by the main-text spatial and network results. Supplementary Fig. S4 summarizes the cap-resolution screening matrix and the centroid-link distance distribution used to construct the spatial-transfer proxy.

Table S6: Spatial-resolution metrics used in the optimization sensitivity.

Metric	k70	k100	k150
Nodes	70	100	150
Annual demand (TWh)	8.234	8.234	8.234
Annual-load CV	0.759	0.767	0.723
Annual-load Gini	0.433	0.435	0.413
Mean intra-node load CV	0.806	0.788	0.739

Table S7: Cap-resolution feasibility screen.

Resolution	1.00	0.40	0.25	0.15	0.14
k70	F	F	LS	LS	CR
k100	F	F	F	F	CR
k150	F	F	LS	LS	CR

Note. F denotes feasible. LS denotes screened by load shedding. CR denotes screened by chronological-replay availability. NE denotes not evaluated in the selected replay configuration. The CR flag identifies the chronological-replay screening boundary for the retained stress-period package. The flag records the stress-period availability condition and leaves feeder-level network infeasibility and full-year chronological feasibility outside this screening table.

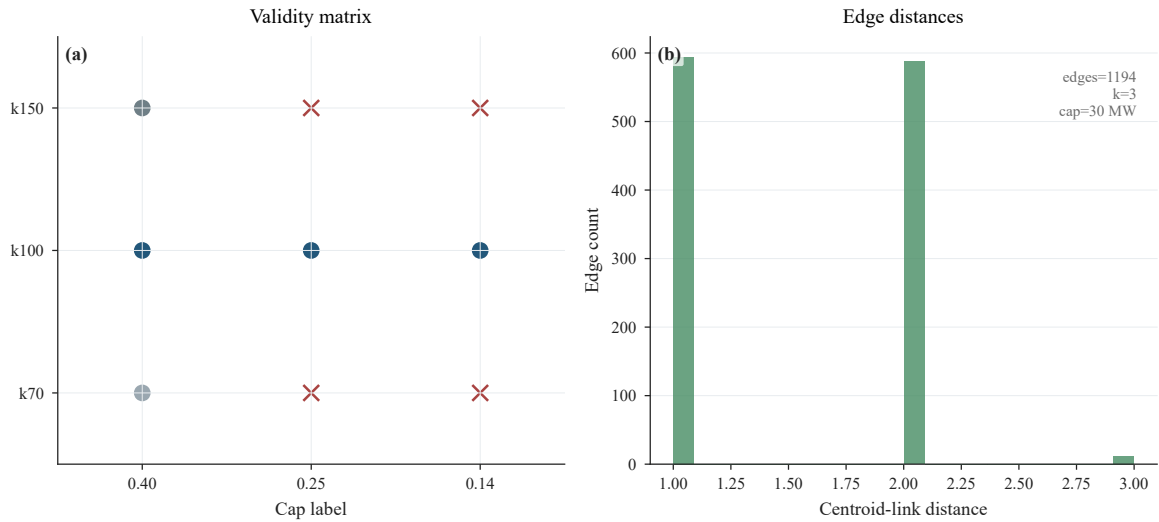
Table S8: Network-abstraction cases at the strict cap.

Case	Internal transfer representation	Cost (bn CNY yr ⁻¹)	BESS (GWh)
Node-interface	Node-specific grid-interface balance	10.723	31.27
Copperplate	Unrestricted internal balancing	6.633	11.62
Spatial-transfer proxy	k -nearest centroid links, 30 MW	7.532	16.78

Table S9: Spatial-transfer proxy summary.

Metric	Value
Raw edge rows	1,194
Unique undirected edges	199
Nearest-neighbour setting	3
Uniform transfer bound	30 MW
Minimum centroid distance	1.000
Maximum centroid distance	3.000

Note. The full edge-list schema and source-file path are documented in the repository README and data-provenance files. The spatial-transfer proxy is constructed from planning-node centroids. For each node, the three nearest neighbouring centroids are selected, and directed neighbour records are symmetrized into a set of unique undirected links. The retained table reports 1,194 raw edge rows and 199 unique undirected links. Each unique link uses a uniform 30 MW transfer bound. The proxy tests sensitivity to limited internal spatial balancing at the planning scale. AC distribution-network assessment requires feeder topology, electrical parameters, voltage constraints, protection settings, and reliability criteria.

**Figure S4:** Spatial-resolution feasibility and spatial-transfer proxy summary. The figure summarizes cap-resolution feasibility outcomes and the centroid-based transfer-link construction used in the spatial-transfer proxy.

S4 Temporal representation and chronological replay

The baseline formulation uses representative periods for capacity expansion and selected 168 h chronological replays for operating-period sensitivity. Table S10 reports the compact temporal configuration, while Tables S11 and S12 report the retained sensitivity and replay outcomes. Supplementary Fig. S5 provides the corresponding visual summary.

Table S10: Representative-period configuration.

Setting	Value
Baseline temporal mode	Representative days
Stored baseline days	8
Weight normalization	8,760 h
Sensitivity cases	7, 14, 21, 30 days
Selection feature	Daily district-load profile

Note. The stored representative days are 2017-01-05, 2017-01-22, 2017-04-02, 2017-05-23, 2017-07-27, 2017-07-30, 2017-10-19, and 2017-11-11 with annual weights 63, 27, 26, 66, 66, 26, 65, and 26.

Table S11: Representative-period sensitivity.

Days	Cap	Emissions (Mt CO ₂)	Cost (bn CNY yr ⁻¹)	BESS (GWh)
7	0.14	0.688	5.485	10.66
8	0.14	0.676	10.723	31.27
14	0.14	0.688	14.534	53.62
21	0.14	0.688	11.456	39.24
30	0.14	0.688	12.678	43.93
7	0.25	1.228	4.591	3.55
8	0.25	1.207	6.596	11.69
14	0.25	1.229	8.529	20.42
21	0.25	1.229	6.601	14.11
30	0.25	1.229	6.797	16.04

Table S12: Selected chronological replay windows and fixed-capacity outcomes.

Cap	Window	Renew./load	Prorated cap (kt CO ₂)	Emissions (kt CO ₂)	Load shedding (GWh)	Peak import (GW)
0.14	High PV	1.095	17.68	17.68	1.48	1.098
0.14	Peak load	0.640	23.98	23.98	83.66	1.556
0.14	Renewable scarcity	0.314	19.24	19.24	133.14	1.887
0.25	High PV	1.095	31.57	31.57	36.16	1.960
0.25	Peak load	0.640	42.83	42.83	93.54	2.093
0.25	Renewable scarcity	0.314	34.36	34.36	122.58	1.916

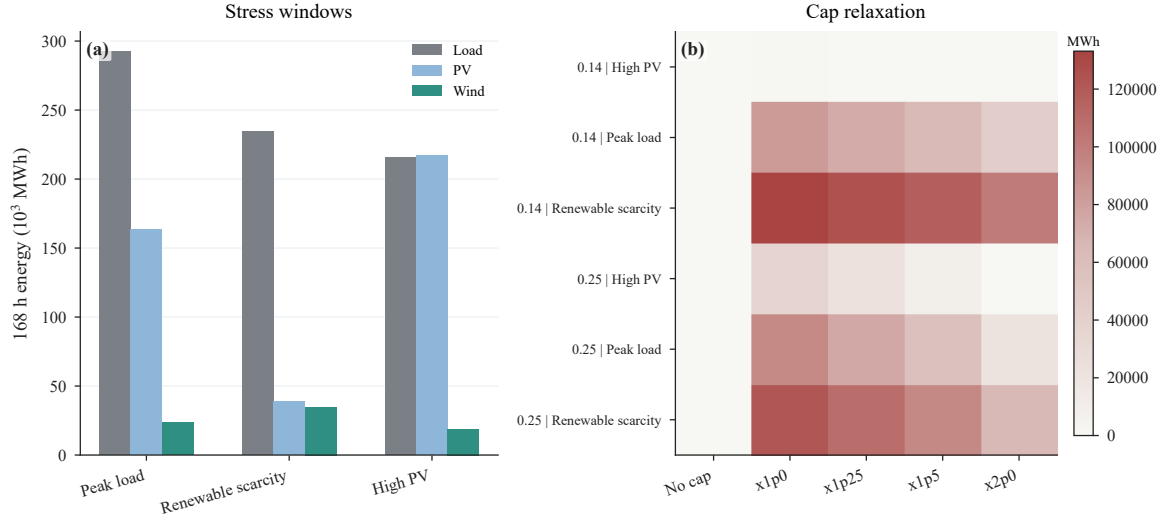


Figure S5: Selected chronological replay windows and cap-relaxation results. Fixed representative-period capacities are evaluated over 168 h peak-load, renewable-scarcity, and high-PV periods to characterize temporal sensitivity under concentrated operating conditions.

S5 Storage lifecycle and flexibility assumptions

Storage is parameterized through power and energy capex, duration, efficiency, lifetime, throughput degradation, and calendar-ageing charges. Table S13 reports the compact assumption set. Tables S14 and S15 report the retained storage and flexibility outcomes, while Supplementary Fig. S6 shows the full calendar-ageing sensitivity.

Table S13: Storage lifecycle and duration assumptions.

Parameter	Li-ion	LDES	Unit
Power capex	700	1,600	CNY kW ⁻¹
Energy capex	1,200	240	CNY kWh ⁻¹
Charge efficiency	0.95	0.82	–
Discharge efficiency	0.95	0.82	–
Lifetime	12	25	yr
Baseline duration	4	24	h
Extended Li-ion duration	8	–	h
Calendar-ageing charges	0, 6, 12, 24	–	CNY kWh ⁻¹ yr ⁻¹
Cycling-throughput charge	0.05	–	CNY kWh ⁻¹

Table S14: Storage sensitivity outcomes.

Case	Cap	Cost (bn CNY yr ⁻¹)	BESS (GWh)	LDES (GWh)	EFC	Calendar (CNY kWh ⁻¹ yr ⁻¹)
Li-ion 4 h legacy	0.14	10.011	31.37	0.00	132.9	0
Li-ion 4 h throughput	0.14	10.347	31.29	0.00	131.6	0
Li-ion 4 h cal. low	0.14	10.535	31.29	0.00	131.6	6
Li-ion 4 h cal. mid	0.14	10.723	31.27	0.00	131.7	12
Li-ion 4 h cal. high	0.14	11.098	31.27	0.00	131.7	24
Li-ion 8 h cal. mid	0.14	10.357	31.43	0.00	131.4	12
Li-ion 8 h + LDES	0.14	8.080	18.39	19.48	158.2	12
Li-ion 4 h legacy	0.25	6.156	12.06	0.00	320.2	0
Li-ion 4 h throughput	0.25	6.455	11.70	0.00	279.1	0
Li-ion 4 h cal. low	0.25	6.526	11.70	0.00	279.1	6
Li-ion 4 h cal. mid	0.25	6.596	11.69	0.00	279.3	12
Li-ion 4 h cal. high	0.25	6.736	11.69	0.00	279.3	24
Li-ion 8 h cal. mid	0.25	6.540	11.79	0.00	277.3	12
Li-ion 8 h + LDES	0.25	4.574	0.00	25.20	0.0	12

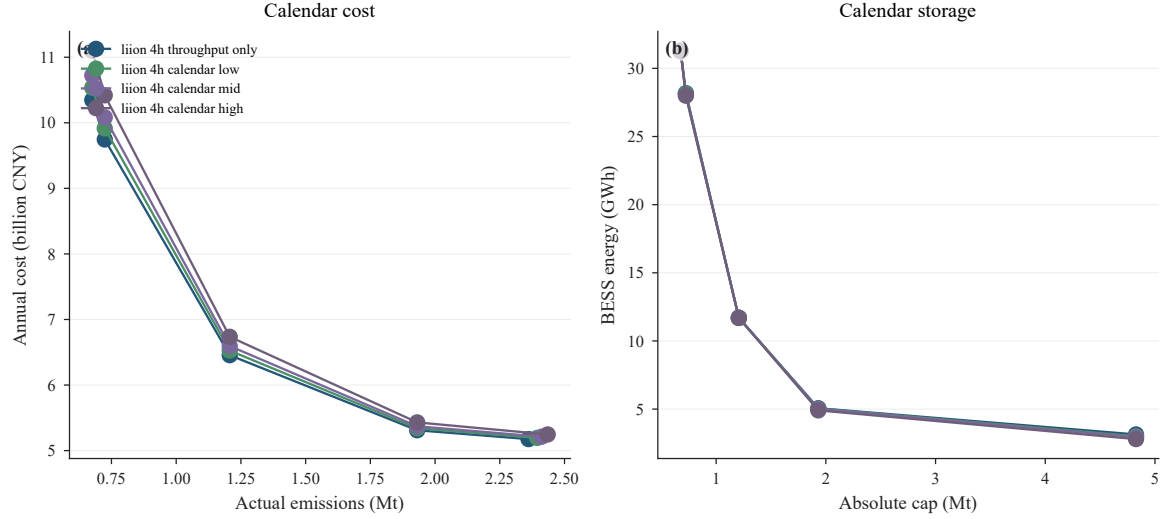


Figure S6: Extended storage calendar-ageing sensitivity. The figure compares storage lifecycle cases across emission-cap levels and complements the main-text storage frontier by listing the full calendar-ageing sensitivity set.

Table S15: Flexibility outcomes.

Case	Cap	Cost (bn CNY yr ⁻¹)	BESS (GWh)	DR shift (GWh)	Thermal shift (GWh)	DR peak (MW)	Thermal peak (MW)
Baseline	0.14	10.723	31.27	0.00	0.00	0.0	0.0
DR only	0.14	10.687	31.15	76.09	0.00	131.7	0.0
Thermal only	0.14	10.686	31.15	0.00	76.09	0.0	131.7
DR + thermal	0.14	10.654	31.05	67.73	74.90	133.0	135.4
Baseline	0.25	6.596	11.69	0.00	0.00	0.0	0.0
DR only	0.25	6.563	11.56	88.14	0.00	142.4	0.0
Thermal only	0.25	6.562	11.56	0.00	88.15	0.0	142.4
DR + thermal	0.25	6.532	11.45	77.84	86.84	142.4	142.4

S6 Extended uncertainty analysis

The uncertainty experiment uses Latin hypercube sampling with seed 42 and 150 requested samples. PRCC values are computed for the retained valid rows at cap labels 0.25 and 0.14, with 60 retained valid rows at cap 0.25 and 31 retained valid rows at cap 0.14. Table S16 reports the sampled ranges, while Table S17 reports the retained signed PRCC coefficients. The sampling design treats uncertain inputs as independent because district-specific empirical joint distributions linking demand scale, renewable-resource bias, technology costs, tariff levels, grid-interface capacity, flexibility uptake, and grid-carbon factors are not available in the retained data package. The PRCC rankings are therefore interpreted as conditional monotonic sensitivity rankings under independent LHS sampling.

Table S16: Uncertain input ranges.

Parameter	Range	Unit
Demand scale	0.901–1.099	multiplier
PV potential scale	0.802–1.198	multiplier
PV capacity-factor scale	0.900–1.099	multiplier
Wind potential scale	0.701–1.300	multiplier
Wind capacity-factor scale	0.801–1.198	multiplier
Grid-interface capacity scale	0.802–1.197	multiplier
Grid carbon-factor scale	0.803–1.200	multiplier
PV capex	4,001.739–6,495.416	CNY kW ⁻¹
Wind capex	9,000.217–11,993.936	CNY kW ⁻¹
BESS power capex	501.746–998.499	CNY kW ⁻¹
BESS energy capex	1,001.138–1,497.222	CNY kWh ⁻¹
BESS degradation cost	0.001–0.120	CNY kWh ⁻¹
Time-of-use tariff scale	0.851–1.199	multiplier
Demand-response fraction	0.001–0.150	share

Table S17: Top-ranked signed PRCC coefficients.

Cap	Outcome	Parameter	PRCC	<i>n</i>
0.14	Emissions	BESS energy capex	-0.626	31
0.14	Emissions	PV potential scale	0.594	31
0.14	Emissions	Grid-interface capacity scale	0.553	31
0.14	Emissions	Demand scale	-0.416	31
0.14	Emissions	Demand-response fraction	-0.342	31
0.14	Emissions	Wind capex	-0.245	31
0.14	Emissions	Time-of-use tariff scale	0.223	31
0.14	Emissions	BESS power capex	-0.202	31
0.14	Emissions	Wind capacity-factor scale	-0.168	31
0.14	Emissions	Grid carbon-factor scale	-0.142	31
0.14	BESS	Grid carbon-factor scale	0.847	31
0.14	BESS	Demand scale	0.843	31
0.14	BESS	PV potential scale	-0.825	31
0.14	BESS	PV capacity-factor scale	-0.641	31
0.14	BESS	Wind capacity-factor scale	-0.436	31
0.14	BESS	Grid-interface capacity scale	-0.332	31
0.14	BESS	BESS power capex	0.246	31
0.14	BESS	Demand-response fraction	0.213	31
0.14	BESS	BESS energy capex	-0.206	31
0.14	BESS	Time-of-use tariff scale	0.130	31
0.14	Grid import	Grid carbon-factor scale	-1.000	31
0.14	System cost	Demand scale	0.879	31
0.14	System cost	Grid carbon-factor scale	0.839	31
0.14	System cost	PV capacity-factor scale	-0.829	31
0.14	System cost	PV potential scale	-0.818	31
0.14	System cost	BESS energy capex	0.723	31
0.14	System cost	PV capex	0.603	31
0.14	System cost	BESS degradation cost	0.484	31
0.14	System cost	Grid-interface capacity scale	-0.403	31
0.14	System cost	Demand-response fraction	0.388	31
0.14	System cost	BESS power capex	0.388	31
0.25	Emissions	Grid-interface capacity scale	-0.259	60
0.25	Emissions	PV capacity-factor scale	-0.247	60
0.25	Emissions	Wind capacity-factor scale	0.239	60
0.25	Emissions	Wind potential scale	0.174	60
0.25	Emissions	BESS energy capex	0.162	60
0.25	Emissions	Grid carbon-factor scale	-0.112	60
0.25	Emissions	PV capex	-0.074	60
0.25	Emissions	Time-of-use tariff scale	0.068	60
0.25	Emissions	Demand scale	0.044	60
0.25	Emissions	BESS power capex	-0.041	60
0.25	BESS	Demand scale	0.959	60
0.25	BESS	Grid carbon-factor scale	0.943	60

Cap	Outcome	Parameter	PRCC	<i>n</i>
0.25	BESS	PV potential scale	-0.875	60
0.25	BESS	PV capacity-factor scale	-0.621	60
0.25	BESS	BESS power capex	-0.197	60
0.25	BESS	BESS degradation cost	-0.161	60
0.25	BESS	Demand-response fraction	0.157	60
0.25	BESS	Time-of-use tariff scale	0.151	60
0.25	BESS	Grid-interface capacity scale	0.097	60
0.25	BESS	Wind potential scale	-0.077	60
0.25	Grid import	Grid carbon-factor scale	-1.000	60
0.25	System cost	Demand scale	0.965	60
0.25	System cost	Grid carbon-factor scale	0.888	60
0.25	System cost	PV potential scale	-0.825	60
0.25	System cost	PV capex	0.778	60
0.25	System cost	PV capacity-factor scale	-0.757	60
0.25	System cost	BESS energy capex	0.750	60
0.25	System cost	BESS degradation cost	0.562	60
0.25	System cost	Wind capacity-factor scale	-0.424	60
0.25	System cost	Time-of-use tariff scale	0.403	60
0.25	System cost	BESS power capex	0.301	60

Note. The complete machine-readable PRCC table is documented in the repository README and data-provenance files.

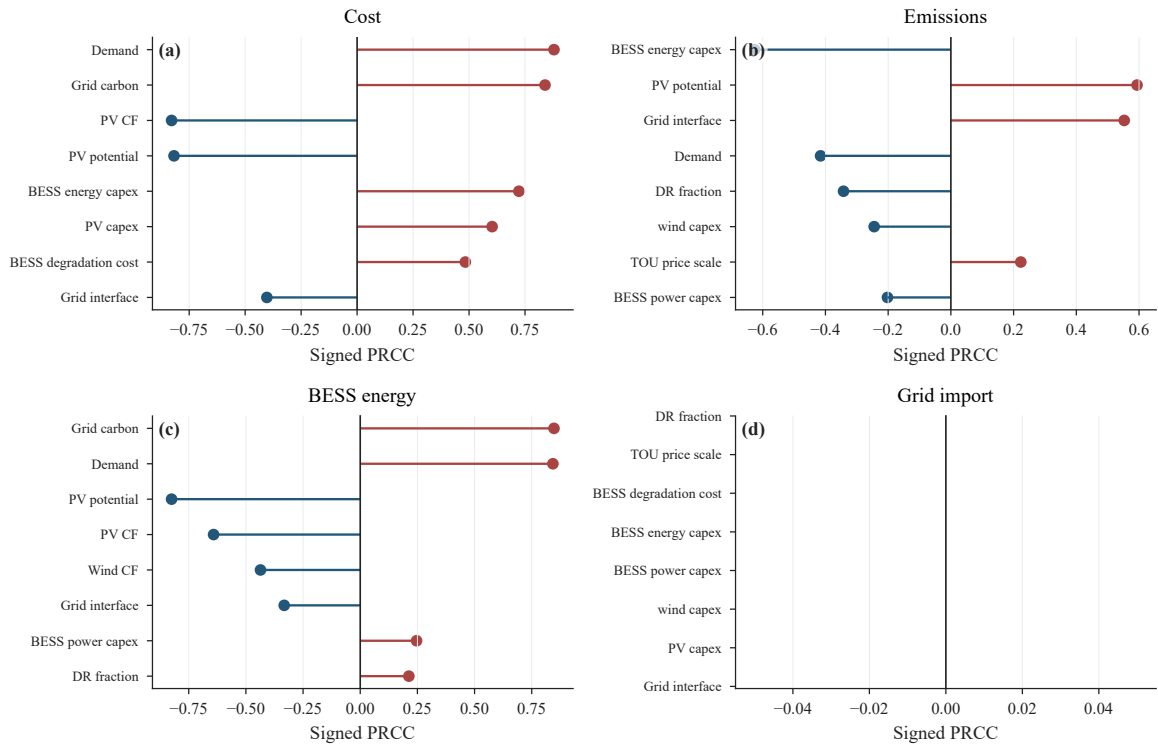


Figure S7: Extended PRCC rankings by outcome and emission-cap level. Signed coefficients are retained to indicate whether each uncertain input increases or decreases the corresponding cost, emissions, storage, or import metric.

S7 Marginal-abatement and limiting-constraint results

This section provides the numerical detail behind the marginal-abatement and bottleneck diagnostics in the main text. The finite-difference MAC values describe interval-average cost changes between adjacent frontier points, while the dual-based MAC values describe local shadow-price information for the CO₂ cap constraint in the retained linear formulation. The limiting-constraint counts identify which constraint

families bind most frequently at each cap level, and the 1% relaxation tests quantify how annualized system cost changes when selected resource, interface, or storage-duration bounds are relaxed. Together, these results support the interpretation of the cost–emission envelope as a diagnostic object instead of only a descriptive frontier.

Table S18: MAC comparison by cap.

Cap	Finite-difference MAC (CNY tCO ₂ ⁻¹)	Dual-based MAC (CNY tCO ₂ ⁻¹)	Difference (CNY tCO ₂ ⁻¹)
0.40	330.6	850.3	519.7
0.25	1,691.6	2,773.4	1,081.8
0.15	7,224.0	12,785.2	5,561.2
0.14	13,256.6	13,304.4	47.8

Table S19: Binding counts by cap.

Cap	Constraint family	Binding count
0.25	BESS charge power	1,366
0.25	BESS discharge power	12
0.25	BESS duration	100
0.25	BESS energy bound	2,020
0.25	CO ₂ cap	1
0.25	Grid interface	284
0.14	BESS charge power	2
0.14	BESS discharge power	0
0.14	BESS duration	100
0.14	BESS energy bound	802
0.14	CO ₂ cap	1
0.14	Grid interface	320

Table S20: One-percent relaxation results.

Cap	Relaxed family	Cost relief (bn CNY yr ⁻¹)	Top nodes
0.14	PV potential	0.0194	k100_0084, k100_0069, k100_0029
0.14	Battery duration	0.0075	GLOBAL
0.14	Wind potential	0.0031	k100_0084, k100_0069, k100_0049
0.14	Grid capacity	0.0000	k100_0034, k100_0011, k100_0025
0.25	PV potential	0.0039	k100_0084, k100_0069, k100_0029
0.25	Battery duration	0.0028	GLOBAL
0.25	Wind potential	0.0006	k100_0084, k100_0069, k100_0049
0.25	Grid capacity	-0.0000	k100_0034, k100_0011, k100_0033

S8 Solver settings, feasibility screening, and reproducibility materials

This section retains the repository-facing material needed for reconstruction and auditing. Tables S21–S22 keep only the compact numerical settings and screening thresholds needed to interpret the public package. Repository locations, source categories, and data-provenance details are documented in the repository README and data-provenance files.

Table S21: Optimization solver and numerical settings.

Setting	Value
Solver	scipy-linprog-highs
Status	optimal
Representative runtime	29.91 s
Objective at cap 0.14	10.723 bn CNY yr ⁻¹
Stored representative days	8
Load-shedding penalty	100,000 CNY kWh ⁻¹
Discount rate	0.06
Planning horizon	20 yr
PV capex / lifetime	5,000 CNY kW ⁻¹ / 25 yr
Wind capex / lifetime	10,000 CNY kW ⁻¹ / 25 yr

Table S22: Feasibility-screening thresholds.

Criterion	Threshold	Purpose
Load shedding	$\leq 10^{-6}$ MWh	Accepted row
CO ₂ violation	$\leq 10^{-4}$ ton	Accepted row
Cost consistency	10^{-4} CNY	Reconstructed cost
Objective consistency	$\max(10^{-4} \text{ CNY}, 10^{-10} \text{ relative})$	Solver check
Zero-storage cost	flagged if inconsistent	Storage check